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DJIA 39606.57 ▲ 419.59 1.07% NASDAQ 16708.05 ▲ 2.5% STOXX 600 516.77 ▲ 1.8% 10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 1/32, yield 4.385% OIL \$62.27 ▼ \$1.40 GOLD \$3,276.30 ▼ \$124.50 EURO \$1.1315 YEN 143.44

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Trump's softer stance** on the Fed and trade with China lifted major U.S. stock indexes, with the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow rising 1.7%, 2.5% and 1.1%, respectively. **B1**
- ◆ **Boeing said it is** actively looking to redirect planes that were slated to be sent to Chinese customers after China told its airlines to stop receiving orders from the aircraft maker. **B1**
- ◆ **The European Union** fined Apple and Meta Platforms hundreds of millions of dollars and ordered the companies to comply with the bloc's technology rules. **B1**
- ◆ **Southwest Airlines** is suffering from a pullback in travel demand and the carrier abandoned its full-year business projections in the face of uncertainty about the overall economy. **B3**
- ◆ **Volvo cut its forecast** for North America's truck market as the company reported a decline in deliveries for the first quarter. **B3**
- ◆ **AT&T reported higher** profit and revenue for the first quarter, boosted in part by an increase in acquired customers and a spur of upgrades in response to tariffs. **B4**
- ◆ **Sullivan & Cromwell** is beefing up its practice that defends corporations against shareholder activist attacks. **B2**
- ◆ **The owner of Gucci** and YSL posted lower first-quarter sales, undershooting analysts' forecasts amid a slowdown in luxury-goods spending. **B3**
- ◆ **Lysol maker Reckitt** said the schedule for its plans to unload a portfolio of home-care brands might lag because of market conditions. **B2**

World-Wide

- ◆ **The Trump administration** is considering slashing its steep tariffs on Chinese imports, in some cases by more than half, in a bid to de-escalate tensions with Beijing that have roiled global trade and investment. **A1**
- ◆ **Higher tariffs** and heightened geopolitical tensions may push government debts to new highs in coming years, putting pressure on policymakers, the International Monetary Fund said. **A4**
- ◆ **Trump signed** an executive order cracking down on foreign funding at universities, a key point of contention in the administration's battle with Harvard. **A3**
- ◆ **Secretary of State** Marco Rubio outlined a possible compromise with Iran aimed at preventing it from building a nuclear weapon. **A9**
- ◆ **Talks to end** the war in Ukraine are stalled, leaving Trump frustrated and blaming Zelensky for failing to accept a U.S. peace plan. **A6**
- ◆ **Births in the U.S.** hovered near record-low rates last year, with the total fertility rate far below that needed for a generation to replace itself. **A3**
- ◆ **Sen. Dick Durbin** said that he won't run again, setting off a Democratic scramble in Washington and Illinois. **A3**
- ◆ **Scientists sent** quantum information across a record-breaking 158 miles using ordinary computers and fiber-optic cables, an advance toward better encryption. **A2**
- ◆ **Disgraced Hollywood** producer Harvey Weinstein is back on trial on sex-crime charges after his prior conviction was overturned. **A3**

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Thousands Throng the Vatican to Mourn Pope Francis



LAST RESPECTS: The faithful file through St. Peter's Basilica on Wednesday, the start of three days of public viewing before the pontiff's funeral Saturday. **A6**

Fear of Market Pain Spurred President To Drop Fed Threats

WASHINGTON—President Trump said this week that he never had any plans to fire Federal Reserve Chair Jerome Powell, accusing the media of pushing a false narrative that

*By Brian Schwartz,
Josh Dawsey
and Nick Timiraos*

he was out to get the central bank chief.

But inside the White House, some senior officials took Trump's recent public musings about terminating

Powell seriously.

As Trump's criticism of the Fed chair ramped up over the past week, White House lawyers privately reviewed legal options for attempting to remove Powell, including whether they could do so for "cause," according to people familiar with the matter. The laws that created the Federal Reserve say Fed governors can only be removed before their term ends for cause, which courts have generally interpreted to mean malfeasance or

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Trump Weighs His Options On Cutting China Tariffs

Beijing signals it is open to trade talks, but not amid threats from White House

The Trump administration is considering slashing its steep tariffs on Chinese imports—in some cases by more

*By Gavin Bade,
Lingling Wei,
Josh Dawsey
and Alex Leary*

than half—in a bid to de-escalate tensions with Beijing that have roiled global trade and

investment, according to people familiar with the matter.

President Trump hasn't made a final determination, the people said, adding that the discussions remain fluid and several options are on the table. One administration official said Trump wouldn't act unilaterally and would need to see some action from Beijing to lower tariffs.

One senior White House official said the China tariffs were likely to come down to between roughly 50% and 65%.

The administration is also considering a tiered approach similar to the one proposed by the House committee on China

late last year: 35% levies for items the U.S. deems not a threat to national security, and at least 100% for items deemed as strategic to the U.S.'s interest, some of the people said. The bill proposed

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Economic Fallout

- ◆ **Huge stock swings** are new normal..... **B1**
- ◆ **Boeing leans on backlog** amid tariffs..... **B1**
- ◆ **Streetwise: Markets think** they hold the cards**B1**
- ◆ **Heard on the Street: Risk** of capital flight.....**B10**

In Latest Twist, Will Discovered For Zappos Boss Hsieh

*By ANGEL AU-YEUNG
AND KATHERINE SAYRE*

When troubled entrepreneur Tony Hsieh died in a fire, he left behind thousands of sticky notes on the walls of his home in Park City, Utah, many promising millions of dollars to former colleagues and friends.

With no sign of a will, the former Zappos CEO's family and the circle of hangers-on who witnessed his descent into alcohol and drug abuse spent years fighting over his estate in court. Now, a mysterious court filing found in the possessions of a dead man suggests Hsieh may have left behind a legal record of his final wishes.

Hsieh amassed a fortune from the sale of online shoe retailer Zappos to Amazon for \$1.2 billion and from investments in property across downtown Las Vegas, his adopted hometown.

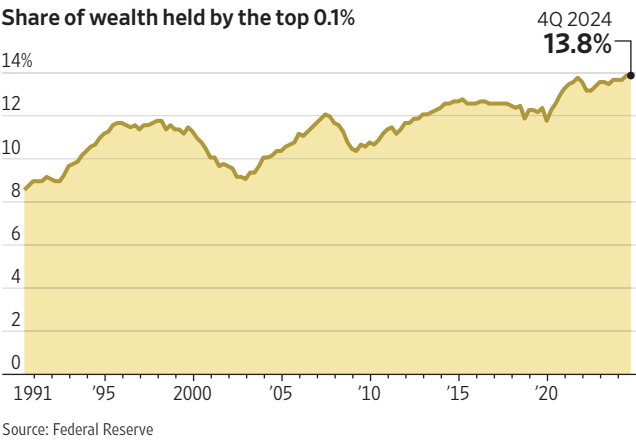
A document that appears to be Hsieh's will was included in a recent court filing, a surprising development in an already bizarre and dramatic fight over his fortune. Signed in early 2015, the document suggests Hsieh crafted a vision for the future of his money after all, one he intended to keep secret from his beneficiaries.

"By doing so, I have structured my way of surprising and leaving essentially all my beneficiaries to experience the

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The Rich Get Even Richer

Soaring stocks helped supercharge the wealth of those at the very top. New data suggest \$1 trillion of wealth was created for the 19 richest American households alone in 2024. **A2**



The Impossible Four-Hour Test To Become a Tariff Pencil Pusher

Almost everyone fails the open-book exam to be a licensed customs broker; 'pure hell'

By ESTHER FUNG

Suddenly everyone wants a piece of Nunzio De Filippis. He's a U.S. licensed customs broker, which means he handles the paperwork to process imports and calculate duties and fees for products brought into the country. It's a staggeringly tedious job that would be of little interest to anyone in normal times.

But amid a flurry of new tariffs by the Trump administration that seem to change by the hour, brokers say they are fielding back-to-back calls from panicked importers who need help deciphering the shifting picture and minimizing the cost of getting their goods into the U.S.

When De Filippis and other brokers get overwhelmed, they remind themselves they already overcame a far more torturous ordeal: the customs exam.

"I've always prided myself for being a good student, but when I got to that test, I was humbled," said De Filippis, co-CEO of CargoTrans, a freight forwarder and logistics service provider. "Even if you put in the hours, you have to learn how to beat the test."

The 4½ hour, open-book test covers the technicalities of classifying merchandise and entry and valuation procedures. Exam takers, who have to be U.S. citizens 18 years and older, said the 80 multi-

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Chinese Lead Charge On Fast EV Batteries

By YOKO KUBOTA

SHANGHAI—Two of the world's leading battery developers are locked in a technological race that has brought the charging time for an electric vehicle to just five minutes—about the amount of time it takes to refuel a traditional gasoline-powered car.

And, in a twist with geopolitical ramifications, both of the technological leaders are Chinese. It is a show of prowess that underscores just how

far China has extended its global dominance over next-generation technologies, in some cases leaving the U.S. years behind.

The claimed leap forward on EV batteries is the latest technological feat for a country that has stunned Western governments with a string of breakthroughs on artificial intelligence, semiconductors and EVs—a vindication of leader Xi Jinping's ambitions of turning China into a global techno-

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